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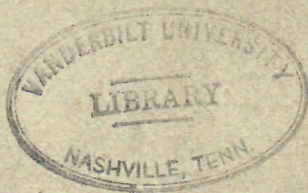
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SHOSHONEAN DIALECTS OF CALIFORNIA

BY

A. L. KROEBER



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The Cahuilla have been and are generally known by this name by both whites and Indians, but its origin is not clear¹. The pronunciation is always Kawia. This being scientifically the more reasonable orthography is perhaps preferable to Cahuilla, and in time may come to supplant it; but the latter form is so well established in literature and geographically that at present at least it is best to accept it. The spelling Coahuilla, and still more Coahuila, are unquestionably unorthographical even in Spanish.

The Luiseño call the Cahuilla Yuhiktom or Kwimguchum (easterners), their speech Yukhakhonpom or Kwimkwangakh.

The Luiseño name for Cahuilla valley is Pawi, for El Toro or Cabezon Wakwi (Barrows: Cabeson, Pal seta), for Los Coyotes Hulawona, for San Ygnacio Sapela (Barrows: Pachawal).

The Chemehuevi call the Cahuilla Kwitanemum (southerners?); the Mohave river Serrano call them Kawayayam.

The Mohave call the Cahuilla Hakwiche. This is perhaps the usual name for the Cahuilla among the Yuman tribes, except among the adjacent Diegueño divisions, who at least now use this name for the Agua Caliente people and call the Cahuilla as do the whites.

A term identical in sound with Cahuilla occurs also in central California as the name of a Yokuts tribe, the Kawia, from which is derived the name of Kaweah river and of two small settlements. While the pronunciation of the two words in northern and southern California is the same, there is nothing to show that this identity is anything but a coincidence².

SANTA BARBARA ISLANDS.

The six inhabited Santa Barbara islands off the coast of Southern California were equally divided between Indians of the Chumash and Shoshonean stocks. The three northern islands,

¹ Reid, in Taylor, Cal. Farmer, XIV, 146, Jan. 11, 1861: "The so-called Cahuillas have been named by Spanish missionaries, through the mistake of taking the word to denote the name of the people. Whereas Cahuilla signifies nothing more than Master." This in connection with a statement that the Gabrielino lack a "distinguishing appellation," and that "it is almost certain that many other tribes are similarly situated," the Cahuilla being the instance.

² Strictly the identity is not absolute. The Shoshonean tribe is Kawi'a, the Yokuts properly Ga'wia.

San Miguel, Santa Rosa, and Santa Cruz, adjoining the coast of Santa Barbara and Ventura counties, were occupied, like this coast strip, by Chumash, whose family appellation, which is only a book name, is derived from the native term for Santa Rosa or its inhabitants. The three southern islands, Santa Catalina, San Clemente, and the outlying San Nicolas, were held by Shoshoneans.¹ Santa Catalina was occupied by people speaking Gabrielino, and its name was Pimu. The Luiseño call the island Pipimar. The affiliations of the inhabitants of San Clemente are not certain. Reid includes the island, under the name Kinkipar, in his list of the principal rancherias of the Gabrielino "Indians of Los Angeles county." The present Gabrielino Indians call the island Kinki, the Luiseño call it Khesh; the latter state that it was inhabited by people speaking their own language, who, after having been brought to the mainland by the Franciscans, were settled at a place three miles below San Luis Rey Mission, to which they gave the same name, Khesh. That San Nicolas island was inhabited by Shoshoneans is evident from the four words preserved of the language of the last survivor, a woman who was alone on the island for eighteen years and died soon after being brought to the mainland half a century ago.² These four words are: man, nache; sky, toygwah; hide, tocah; body, puoo-chay. Toygwah is certainly Shoshonean, as will be seen from a glance at the comparative vocabulary. The place of the San Nicolas island dialect in the general classification of the Shoshonean family cannot, however, be determined from this scanty material, especially as the spelling is English and there is no evidence that the four words are free from errors of typography or copying. It is not impossible that the dialect was fairly close to Gabrielino or Luiseño³, or, on the other hand, that it was much differentiated from all others.

¹ The map in Powers' *Tribes of California* does not commit itself as to the three southern islands and leaves them uncolored. Powell, *Ann. Rep. Bur. Ethn.* VII, 67, states that they were probably inhabited by people of Chumashan family; but the accompanying map colors them as Shoshonean.

² *History of Santa Barbara County*, published by Thompson and West, Oakland, California, 1883.

³ The statement that Indians from Los Angeles and other places, and fathers familiar with all the dialects of the coast, could not understand a word of this woman's language, has the appearance of an overstatement. It must be remembered that she was brought to Santa Barbara, which is in Chumash territory, and that there is no evidence that anyone conversant with Luiseño interviewed her.